

Assignment Submission Sheet

DATA 350

Responsible AI

Unit 6 Assignment: Analyze/Critique Responsible AI Policies

Matthew Kolonich

Professor Green

11/22/2025

Definition of Responsible AI

I would define responsible AI as the practice of creating and using artificial intelligence in a way that protects people, reduces harm, and promotes fairness. In my opinion, responsible AI begins with ethics. I believe it means thinking about how algorithms affect individuals and communities and then making decisions that reflect human values. Responsible AI also means preventing misuse, reducing bias, and promoting transparency. I believe that responsible AI should not simply focus on technical accuracy. I think it must also include the broader social impact of AI systems. Responsible AI should allow people to understand how a system works, why it makes certain decisions, and how their data is used or protected.

The most important aspect of responsible AI for me is transparency. When an AI system is clear about how they were built and what data it used, it then allows people to make informed decisions about trusting the system. Transparency in AI also reduces the likelihood of hidden bias and unfair treatment. Transparency encourages companies to be honest about limitations and to communicate about potential risks. I think the public deserves to know when AI is used, what information it processes, and how its decisions could affect them.

I believe Responsible AI is essential in the development and deployment of modern technologies. Responsible AI in systems helps to build trust and prevent harm. An example is AI models that are used in healthcare. These AI systems have the potential to diagnose diseases earlier and more accurately than a human alone, which can save lives and reduce long term medical costs. This kind of system must be held to high ethical standards because mistakes in medical AI could cause serious damage. A responsible AI approach would include strict testing, clear human oversight, and safeguards that ensure the model does not show bias based on race, gender, or socioeconomic status.

If companies build AI responsibly, society benefits from improved safety, better decision making, and more inclusive outcomes. I believe responsible AI also helps protect democratic values because it encourages fairness and accountability in technology systems that influence daily life. As Hashemi Pour and colleagues explain, AI governance requires a balance of strong oversight, ethical standards, and clear accountability so that companies deploy systems that serve the public interest (Hashemi Pour et al., 2024).

Analysis of the EU Guidelines

I have read the EU Guidelines on Trustworthy AI and I believe they reflect many of the core principles I connect to responsible AI. I defined responsible AI as a framework built on transparency, accountability, fairness, inclusivity, privacy, and the prevention of harm. The EU Guidelines support these same values through their focus on ethical purpose, technical design, and legal compliance. The EU takes a stricter regulatory stance than the United States, and I think that approach helps encourage serious attention to safety and long term social impact. I believe even though no policy is perfect, the overall direction of the EU model aligns well with what I consider responsible AI.

One area where I see that EU Guidelines strongly support responsible AI is in their emphasis on ethics and human oversight. Their framework requires developers to show that AI systems are well tested, technically reliable, and supervised by humans. This helps to prevent incorrect or harmful outcomes. This fits in with my view that trustworthy AI must reduce risk and remain grounded in human judgment. These guidelines also stress transparency by expecting companies to explain how systems work, what data they use, and what limitations they have. Lovells (2024) notes that effective AI governance depends on clear accountability, strong oversight, and continuous adaptation, which matches the direction the EU is aiming for even as the technology evolves.

While the EU has strong framework, the EU approach is not without weaknesses. The most significant concern for me is the delayed enforcement for high risk systems, which will not fully take effect until late 2027(Technology.org, 2025). This delay gives organizations more time to prepare, but it also allows potentially harmful systems to operate with fewer restrictions for several years. Critics worry that this slower timeline may reduce user protection and create uneven global standards. Gopalasamy (2023) explains that the EU AI Act involves complex tiers of risk and detailed obligations for developers, and while the structure is strong, the staged rollout may create gaps in oversight until the full rules become enforceable.

I believe the EU Guidelines contribute meaningfully to the broader goal of ethical and trustworthy AI. They show a commitment to protecting the public, reducing bias, and encouraging responsible innovation. The guidelines the EU uses promote confidence by giving developers clear expectations and encouraging companies to document their processes carefully. I still believe improvements are needed, especially in the timing of enforcement and transparency around training data. The EU's AI regulations approach sets a valuable foundation for responsible AI that other regions can learn from.

References

Gopalasamy, P. (2023, November 13). *Navigating the EU AI act*. OneTrust. <https://www.onetrust.com/blog/navigating-the-eu-ai-act/>

Hashemi-Pour, C., Barney, N., & Lewis, S. (2024, January). *Artificial intelligence (AI) governance*. TechTarget. <https://www.techtarget.com/searchenterpriseai/definition/AI-governance>

Lovells, H. (2024, February 1). *The data chronicles: AI governance | What you need to know* [Video]. YouTube. <https://youtu.be/0G8CDNa9GJ4?si=CJfNrHX7dt-TOECQ>

Technology.org. (2025, November 20). *Big Tech wins for now: EU pushes back stricter AI regulations to 2027*. <https://www.technology.org/2025/11/20/big-tech-wins-for-now-eu-pushes-back-stricter-ai-regulations-to-2027/>